

Case 9: The Rival's Surprise Launch

Domain: Sales and Marketing | Decision Archetype: Competitive Response | Framework: 4A (Awareness, Acceptability, Affordability, Accessibility)

Screenshots compiled by NovaTel's social media team, Sunday night

Twitter/X — @DataDude99: "wait [Rival] just launched FREE unlimited data on weekends?? how is nobody talking about this" (1,200 likes, 340 retweets)

Instagram comment on NovaTel's page: "when is NovaTel gonna do something like this instead of the same boring plans"

Reddit thread — r/IndianTelecom: A user posted a screenshot of the rival's new offer with the caption "This might actually be a big deal for weekend data users." 89 comments, mostly positive, a few skeptical: "sounds good till you check the fine print on speed throttling after 2GB."

WhatsApp forward circulating widely: A poorly designed but widely shared image claiming "[Rival] gives FREE INTERNET WEEKENDS" — technically true but missing the fine print about speed limits after a data cap.

By Monday morning, NovaTel's social team had compiled the reactions into a single deck for leadership. The rival's offer had gone semi-viral over a weekend — but early data suggested it was more buzz than substance. The "free weekend data" was capped at 2GB before speeds dropped to unusable levels, and it was only available to new customers, not existing ones.

Still, the noise was real, and NovaTel's own customers were asking why they didn't have something similar. Leadership had to decide fast: copy the offer, ignore it as gimmicky, or respond differently.

Exhibit 1 — Social Sentiment Snapshot (Weekend Total)

Platform	Mentions	Positive	Skeptical/Negative
Twitter/X	2,100	68%	32%
Instagram comments	640	74%	26%
Reddit	89 comments	55%	45% (fine print concerns)

Exhibit 2 — Rival Offer, Fine Print Check (4A lens)

Factor	Reality
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Awareness	High — went semi-viral organically
Accessibility	New customers only, existing users excluded
Affordability	"Free" — but capped at 2GB before throttling
Acceptability	Mixed — early adopters excited, but complaints starting about speed after cap

Discussion Questions

1. Should NovaTel copy this offer, ignore it, or respond with something different?
2. Is this rival move actually a threat, or mostly noise that will fade once customers hit the fine print?
3. If you were on NovaTel's leadership team, what would you tell customers by Monday afternoon?